TryHackMe Writeup

Snort

DG Interns Hub - Week 3 | **Name: Harini E | Intern ID: DG/15/OCT/CYBER/040**

Platform	TryHackMe (free room)
Room	Snort
Level / path	Medium, SOC Level 1 > Network Security Monitoring
Room time	120 min (as shown on the room page)
Status	Completed, the room progress bar shows 100%
Room link	https://tryhackme.com/room/snort

Overview

This room shows how to use Snort to detect threats in real time, analyse recorded traffic files and identify anomalies. Snort can work as a packet sniffer, a packet logger and an intrusion detection and prevention system, and it is controlled by command line options and by rules. I took it because Snort is the main network tool of this week, where I installed it, added starter rules and wrote a rule for the T1046 Nmap SYN scan.

Topics I completed

Topic	Focus
IDS and IPS basics	What an intrusion detection system and an intrusion prevention system do, and where Snort fits in.
Sniffer mode	Reading live packets and printing them on screen, with options for verbose output, packet data, link layer headers and the interface.
Logger mode	Saving packets to a log folder and reading saved capture files (pcap) back with Snort.
IDS/IPS mode	Running Snort with a configuration file and rules, testing the configuration, and choosing how alerts are shown.
Investigating pcap files	Using Snort on recorded traffic to find suspicious activity.
Writing rules	The structure of a rule: the header (action, protocol, addresses, ports and direction) and the options such as msg and sid.

Snort options covered

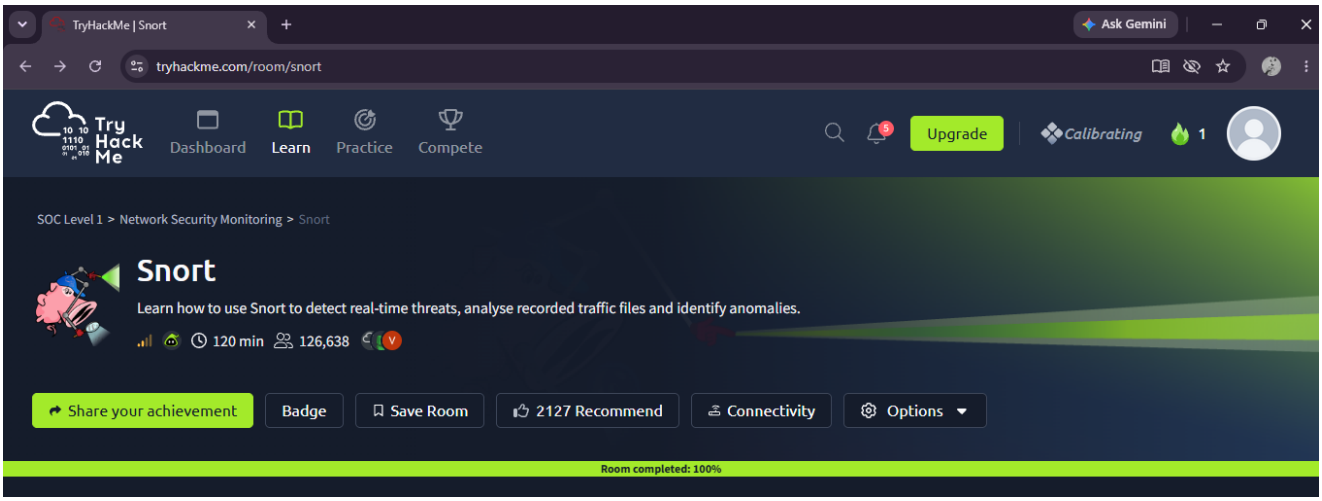
Option	Meaning
-V	Shows the Snort version.
-i	Chooses the network interface to listen on.
-v, -d, -e	Verbose output, packet data and link layer headers in sniffer mode.
-l	Sets the folder where logs are written.
-r	Reads a saved pcap file.

Option	Meaning
-c	Loads a configuration file, which turns on rule based detection.
-T	Tests the configuration without starting detection.
-A	Chooses the alert mode, for example console or fast.
-q	Quiet mode, which hides the startup banner.

What I took from it

Snort is controlled by two things: the command line options decide how it runs, and the rules decide what it looks for. Testing the configuration with -T before starting it saves time and avoids mistakes. A rule needs a clear header and useful options, which is the same structure I used for the three starter rules and for the T1046 SYN scan rule this week.

Evidence



1. Room page showing Snort completed, room progress 100%